Karena Blue

Product designer with a research edge · designedbykarena@gmail.com

Product designer with a research edge and a computer science background. I design navigation, interactions, and interfaces grounded in how people use products, drawing on usability testing, information architecture, prototyping, and front-end development.

Experience

Robotic Process Automation Developer

Jun 2026 – Present

BMO U.S. · Vehicle & Equipment Finance

- Completed UiPath automation development training and began applying RPA concepts to existing business processes, applications, and automation workflows.
- Review existing scripts, process documentation, and application workflows to understand automation logic, dependencies, and support requirements.

UiPath Automation Process Analysis

Rotational Development Program

Jul 2024 – Jun 2026

BMO U.S.

Completed four rotations across Consumer Lending, Retail Payments, Business Process & Optimization, and Risk & Operations.

- Conducted stakeholder interviews, competitive analyses, heuristic reviews, and workflow assessments to identify customer and employee pain points and recommend experience improvements.
- Created current- and future-state process maps using BPMN 2.0 and synthesized qualitative and quantitative findings into recommendations for cross-functional and senior stakeholders.
- Supported product and process strategy across lending, payments, operations, and risk initiatives through research, data analysis, and competitive benchmarking.
- Supported automation and risk initiatives, including Power Automate workflow improvements and employee-access audits across 500+ accounts.

Consumer Lending Retail Payments Business Process & Optimization Risk & Operations

Selected Projects

Sigma Gamma Rho Navigation Redesign

2025–2026

Independent project · Information architecture

Ran a card sort (9 participants) and tree test (9 participants, 10 tasks). All 9 grouped joining with membership, so Membership became a primary category with Become a Member first. Designed desktop and mobile navigation and a clickable prototype; the leadership (55.6%) and programs (62.5%) tasks are the next retest.

SHEIN Filter Recovery & Quick Add

Winter 2026

Team usability study, DePaul HCI 460 · Independent redesign

Moderated sessions in a 5-participant study: only 2 of 5 fully completed filtering despite a mean SUS of 81.5. Compared recovery and quick-add patterns in mid-fi, then designed a one-click empty-state recovery and size-aware quick add with a clickable prototype; not yet tested.

What Goes Into a Post? Observing How People Curate Social Media Content

Autumn 2026

Team observation study · DePaul HCI 445 · In progress

Studying how people curate social posts and how concern about audience perception affects the time they take; findings planned for November 2026.

AI Adoption & Trust in Digital Banking

Nov 2025 – Jan 2026

Self-initiated secondary research · BMO U.S. context

Synthesized published evidence into hypotheses about explanation, review, and user control, with a plan for participant validation.

Education

GRADUATE

M.S. Human–Computer Interaction

DePaul University

Expected June 2027

UNDERGRADUATE

B.S. Computer Science

Roosevelt University

2024

FOUNDATION

Associate in General Studies

Moraine Valley Community College

2022

Skills

Research	UX Research · User Interviews · Usability Testing · Heuristic Evaluation · Card Sorting · Tree Testing · Journey Mapping · Research Synthesis · Think-aloud Testing · SUS & ASQ · Cognitive Walkthrough · KLM Analysis · Competitive Analysis · Task Success & Error Analysis · Success Criteria
Design	Information Architecture · Wireframing · Prototyping · Figma · FigJam · Interaction Design · Responsive Design · Component States · Annotated Screens
Technology	UiPath · HTML · CSS · JavaScript · Power BI · Power Automate · Power Query · Excel · Front-end Implementation · BPMN Process Mapping · RPA